



Kirsty Coventry is new IOC President

“This is a powerful statement. It shows that we are **truly global**, that we have evolved into an organisation open to diversity, and that we will continue on this path over the next eight years,” Coventry said.

Team Sportstar
sportstar@thehindu.co.in

Kirsty Coventry, elected as the 10th president of the International Olympic Committee (IOC), became the first woman and the first African to hold the most powerful position in world

sport. The 41-year-old from Zimbabwe was the sole female candidate among seven contenders in the months-long election.

She is also the youngest IOC president since co-founder Baron Pierre de Coubertin in the late 19th century.

A decorated swimmer, she holds seven of Zimbabwe’s eight Olympic

medals, including golds from the 2004 and 2008 Games.

Her election victory comes a year after the Paris 2024 Olympics achieved full gender parity, reinforcing the IOC’s commitment to diversity and progress. Up until 1981, no women were members of the organisation. Coventry is only the second to run for its presidency.